

Beginners should focus on features that will support their growth as DJs

In conversation with **Rahul Dev Sarma**, Director Sales, Professional Audio, Alphatec

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Q What are some of the key trends that you see emerging in the DJ and music production space in India?

A One notable trend is the increasing acceptance of new technologies like controllers among DJs. Initially, there was some resistance to using controllers because DJs were more comfortable with traditional equipment. However, over the past year or two, controllers have gained popularity as they connect easily to computers, allowing DJs to link their equipment to their digital music libraries. Companies, including Pioneer DJ, which holds over 80% of the market share, have responded by offering a comprehensive range of controllers from entry-level to professional models. These products are now widely accepted and are driving significant changes in the market. Additionally, there's a growing trend of integrating software and hardware to create seamless DJing experiences. The rise of live streaming and virtual performances has also pushed DJs to adopt more versatile and technologically advanced equipment.

Q How do you see the future of the DJ equipment market in India, especially with the projected significant growth over the coming years?

A India is an emerging market not only for DJ equipment but also for the broader audio-video equipment industry. Compared to the global market, we estimate that the DJ equipment market in India will grow at a remark-



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able rate. This rapid growth is indicative of India's increasing importance in the global music industry landscape. The proliferation of music festivals and events, along with a surge in home studio setups, is driving this expansion. Moreover, the Indian audience's growing appreciation for electronic music and DJ culture is encouraging more investments and innovations in this sector.

Q Given the budget that DJs operate with, does Pioneer look to expand their lineup to cater to DJs on a budget?

A Absolutely. Pioneer DJ offers products at various price points to cater to

different segments of the market. The range starts with entry-level controllers like the DDJ-200 and extends to professional-grade equipment. For instance, the DDJ-FLX4 is a highly popular, budget-friendly model that's growing rapidly. The brand aims to provide options that allow even beginners to start with Pioneer DJ equipment and upgrade as they progress in their careers. We also understand the importance of providing value for money, which is why budget-friendly products still offer robust features and high-quality performance. This approach ensures that aspiring DJs can access professional-grade equipment without financial strain.

Q Can you give our readers some insight into what they should look for when they are looking to purchase DJ equipment? Especially beginners who are looking to start out in this space.

A Beginners should focus on features that will support their growth as DJs. Pioneer DJ products are designed to be user-friendly and easily upgradable, ensuring that as new generations of equipment are released, DJs can seamlessly adapt. It's also important to consider the software support that comes with the equipment. Rekordbox software is highly popular due to its ease of use and powerful features. Overall, the goal should be to choose equipment that is aspirational and can help them develop their skills. Additionally, looking for equipment with good customer support and a strong community presence can be beneficial. Engaging with online forums and attending workshops can provide valuable insights and help beginners make informed decisions.